

Bridging the Strategy-Execution Gap

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OBJECTIVES

- Explore why strategies fail and the challenges companies encounter
- Draw from my experiences in leading growth and transformation initiatives
- Share a few frameworks for effectively translating strategy into results

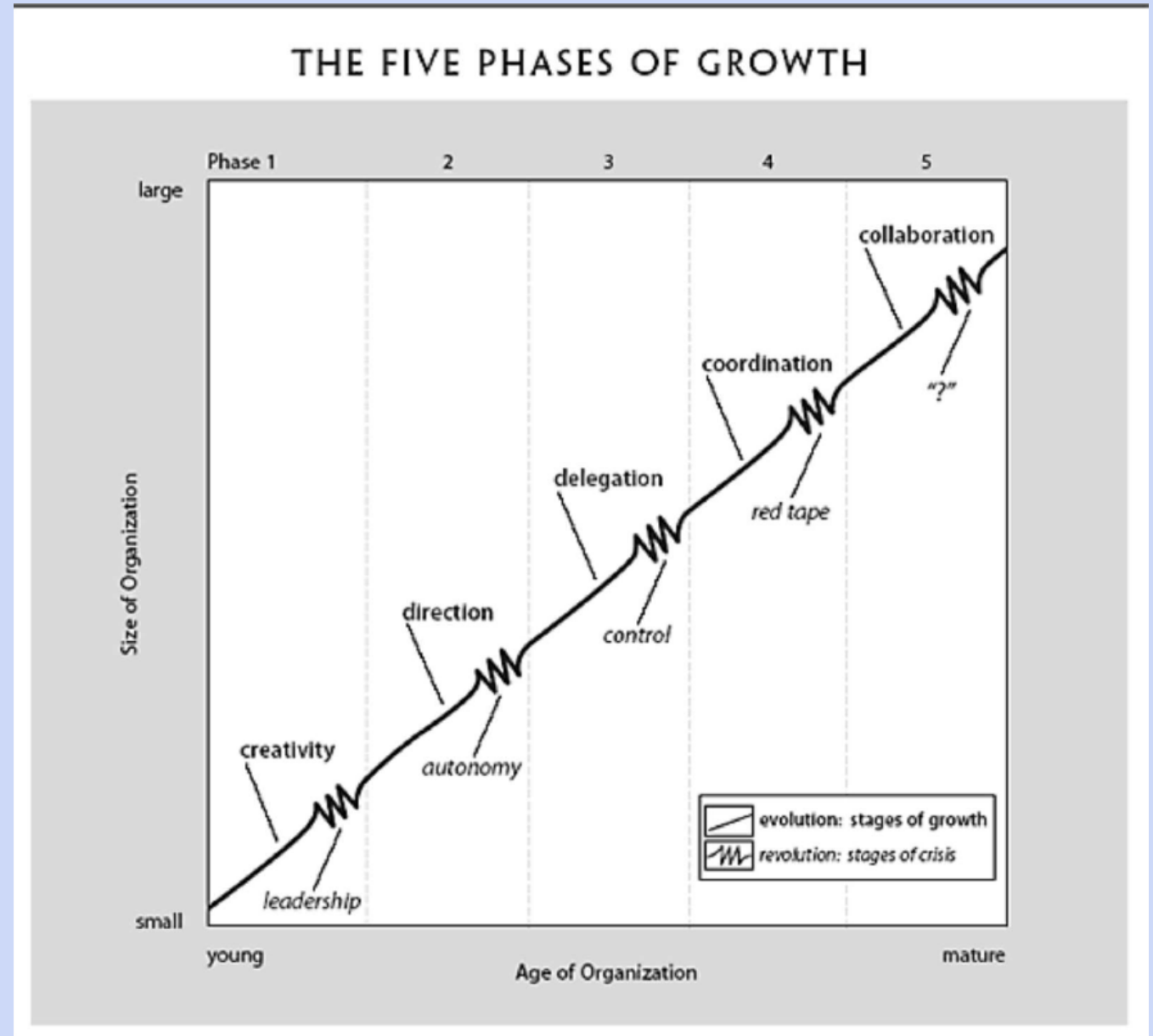
Let's start with context:

- At what frequency do companies evaluate strategy?
- Who is responsible for strategy?
- Why do people develop strategies?



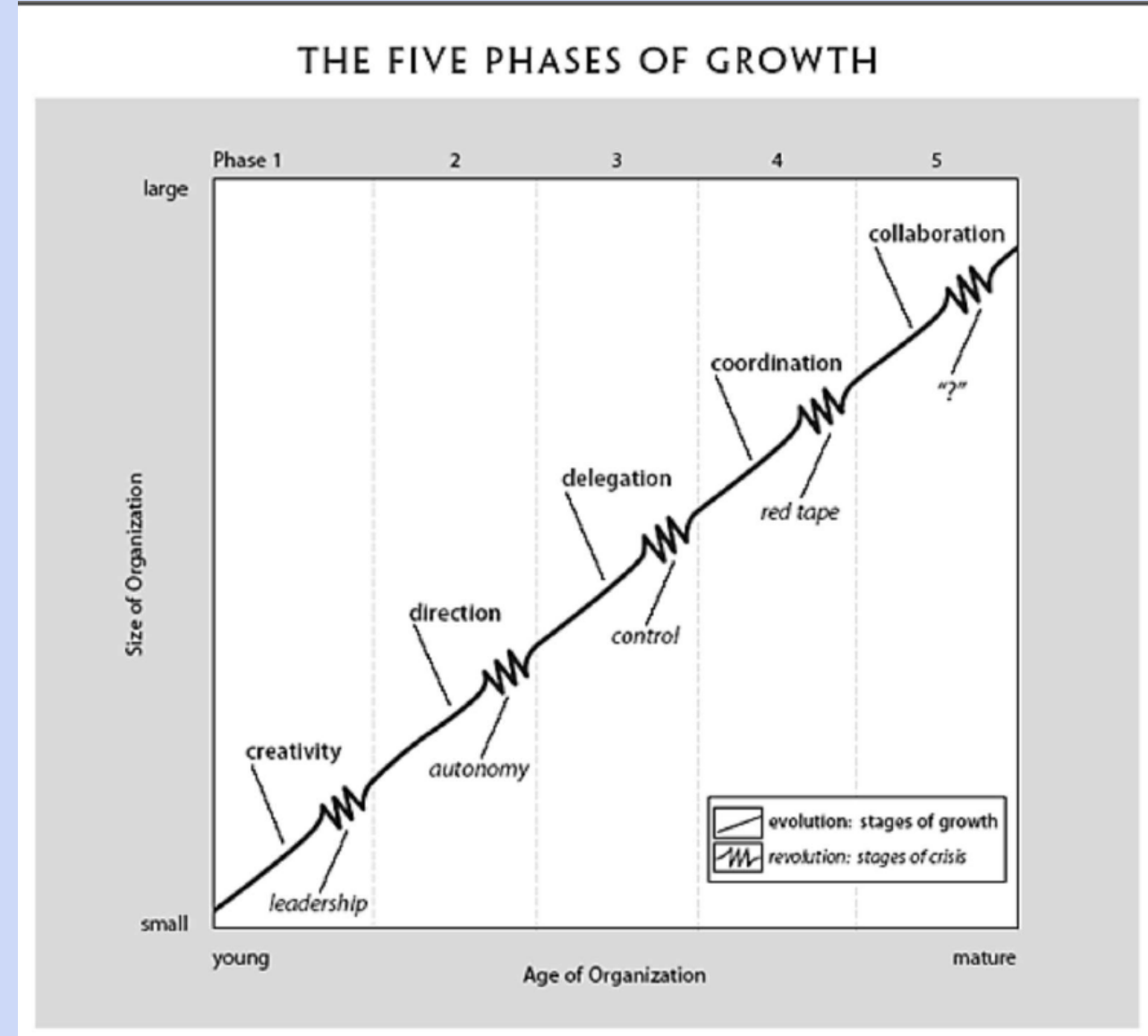
Organizations Grow in Predictable Phases, evolving through a series of distinct growth phases, each characterized by a period of stability (evolution) followed by a disruptive crisis (revolution) that requires change.

Evolution and Revolution as Organizations Grow.
Larry E. Greiner, Harvard Business Review. 1998



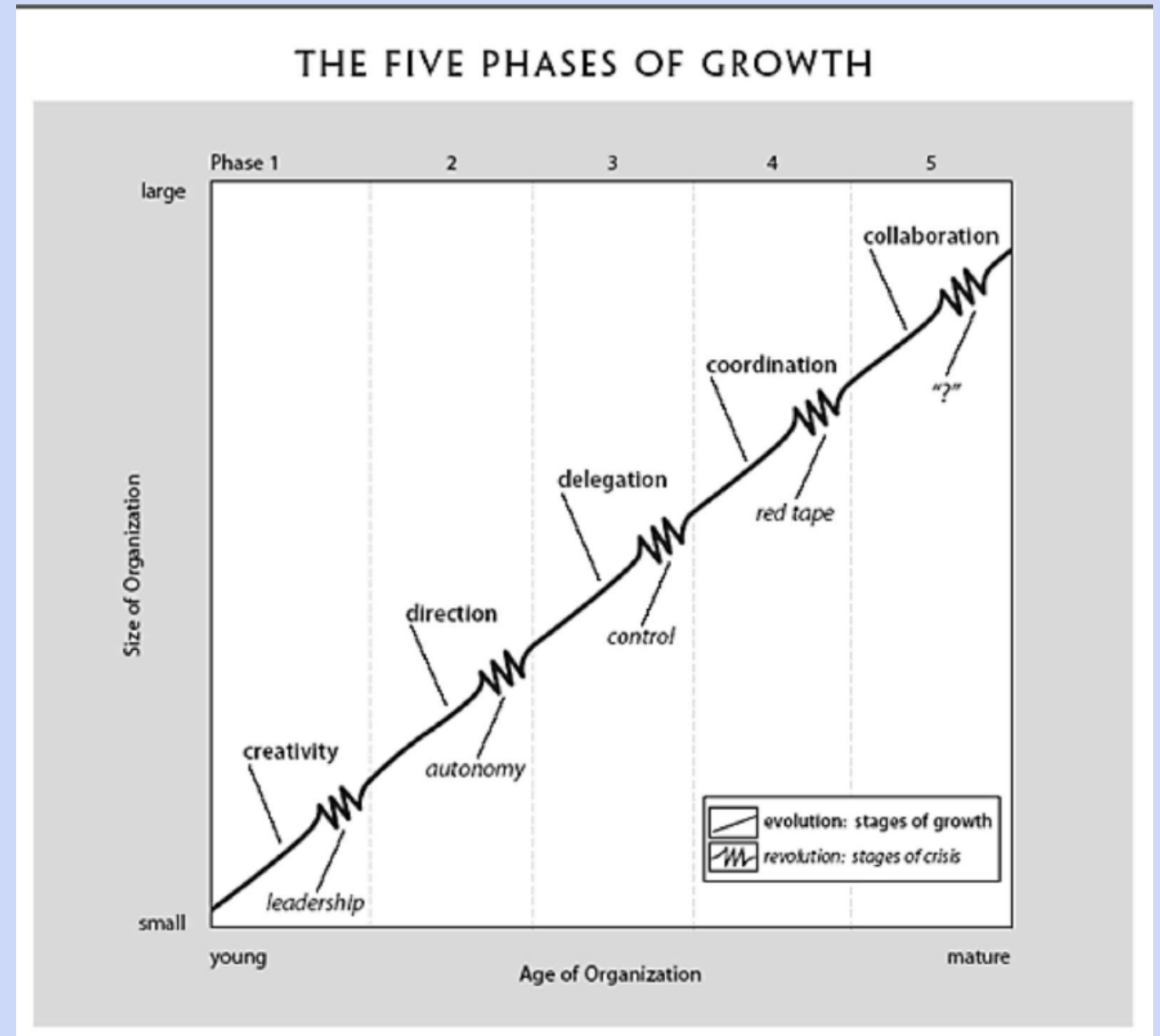
Five Phases of Growth & Crisis:

- Creativity/Leadership Crisis
- Direction/Autonomy Crisis
- Delegation/Control Crisis
- Coordination/Red Tape Crisis
- Collaboration/Internal Growth Crisis



Too often, it is tempting to choose solutions that were tried before, but that actually make it impossible for the new phase of growth to evolve.

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Context matters.

Achieving a strategic objective requires a well-prepared and capable company – one that anticipates and overcomes potential barriers to success.

This starts with assembling the **RIGHT TEAM** – people with a proven track record of guiding companies through different phases of growth.

According to Harvard Business School Professor Robert Kaplan's book, *The Balanced Scorecard: Translating Strategy into Action*, 90% of organizations fail to execute their strategies successfully.

Most strategies fail, but why?

1. Lack of clear vision
2. Poor execution
3. Resistance to change
4. Insufficient resources/skills/capabilities
5. Failure to adapt to changing conditions
6. Weak performance measurement
7. Too much at once

The Strategy Cycle

Strategy



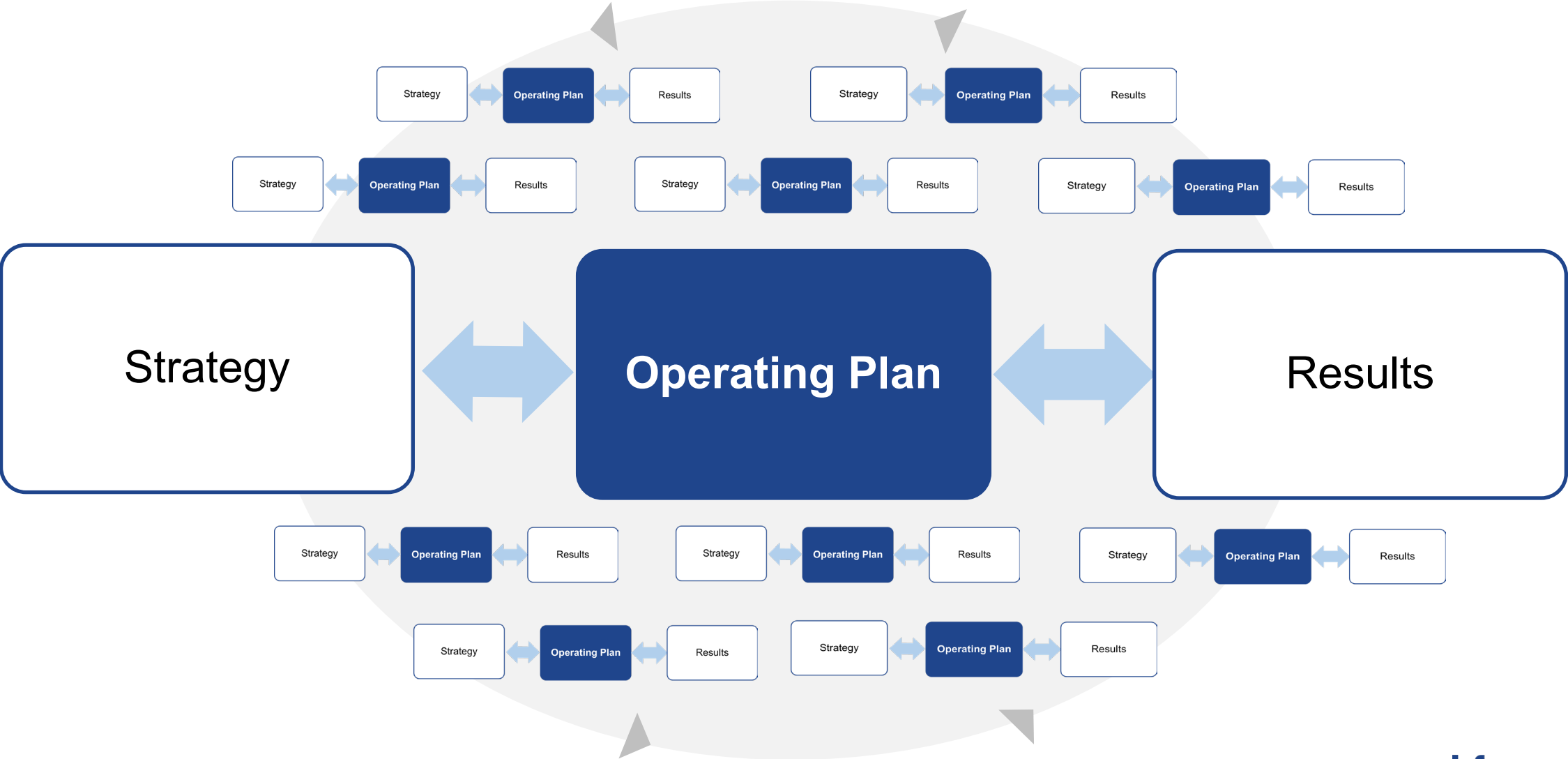
Results

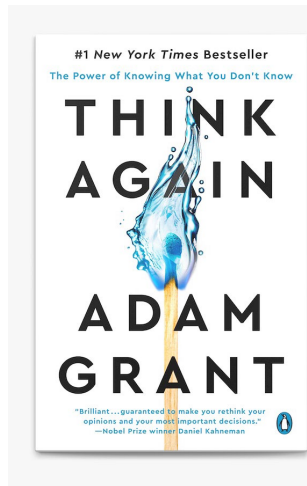
“No battle
plan ever
survives
contact with
the enemy.”

Helmuth von Moltke the Elder
Prussian general
born October 26, 1800



The Strategy Cycle





Recommended
reading:
Think Again,
Adam Grant

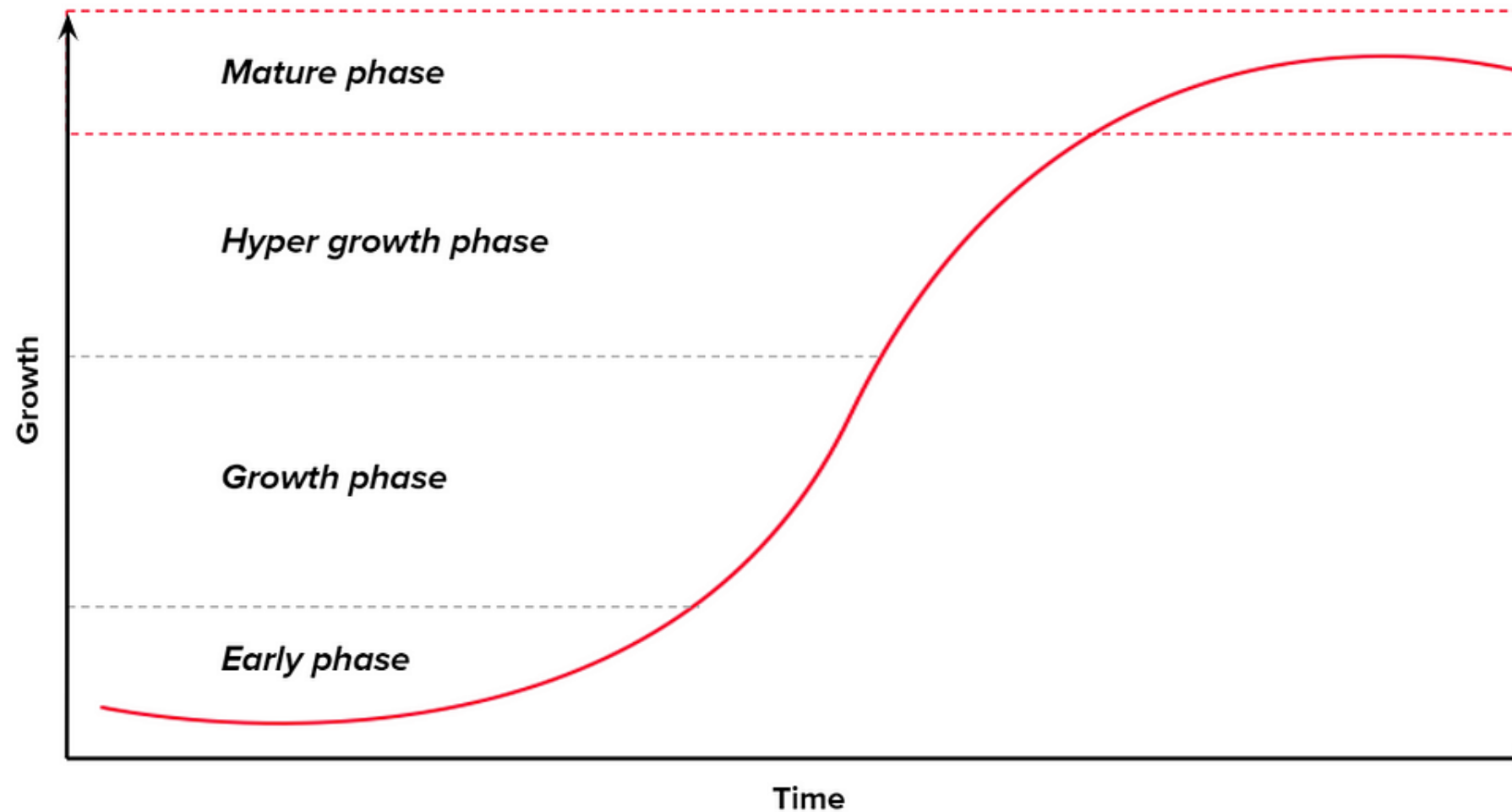
Think Again: The Power of Knowing What You Don't Know.

Adam Grant emphasizes the importance of **rethinking** and **unlearning**. He suggests that intelligence is traditionally viewed as the ability to think and learn, but in a rapidly changing world, there's another set of cognitive skills that might matter more: the ability to *rethink and unlearn*.

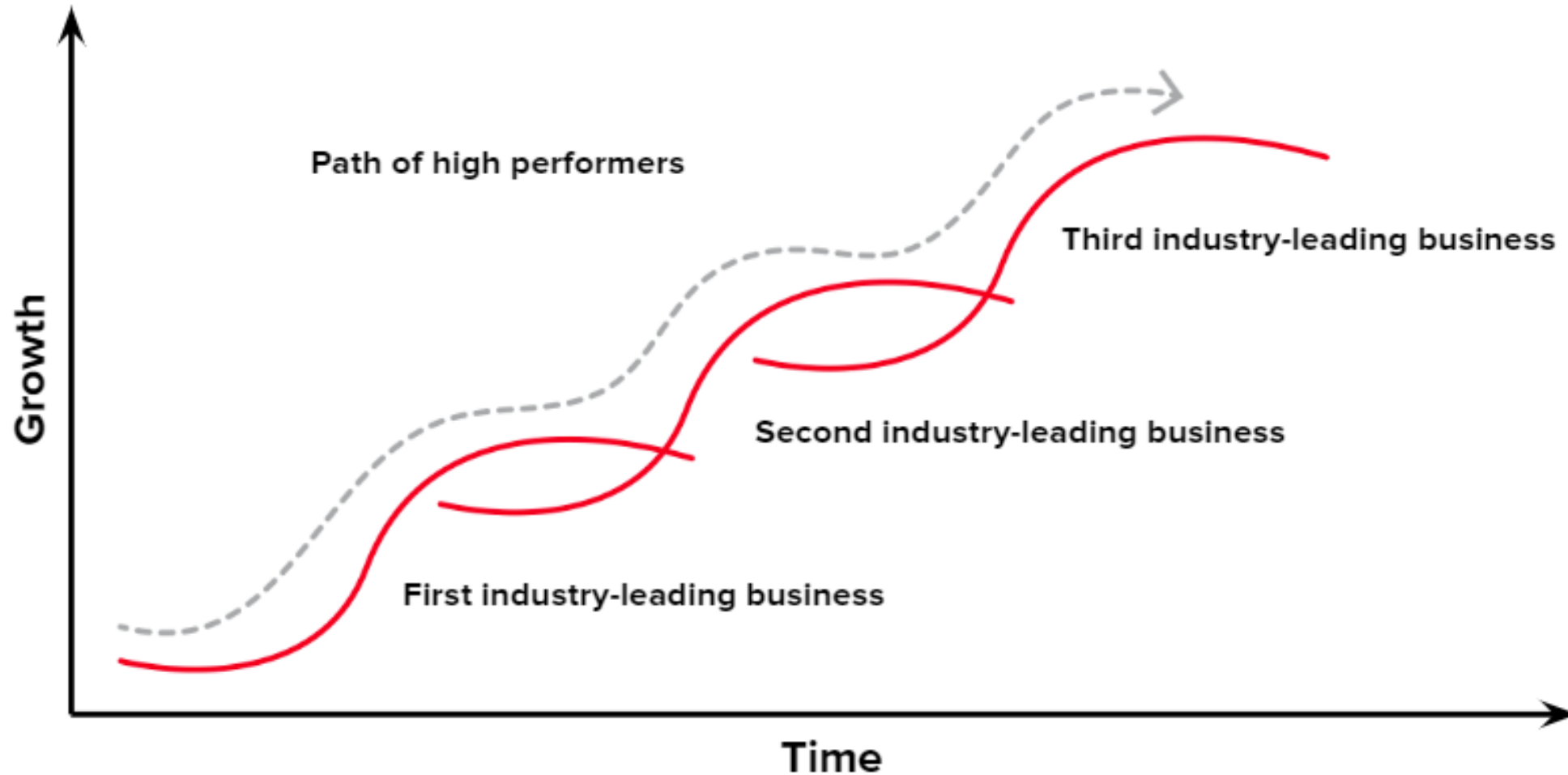
Failure is an enabler of growth.

Growth and forward momentum require grit and determination – constantly evaluating, rethinking, and unlearning to refine your strategy for success.

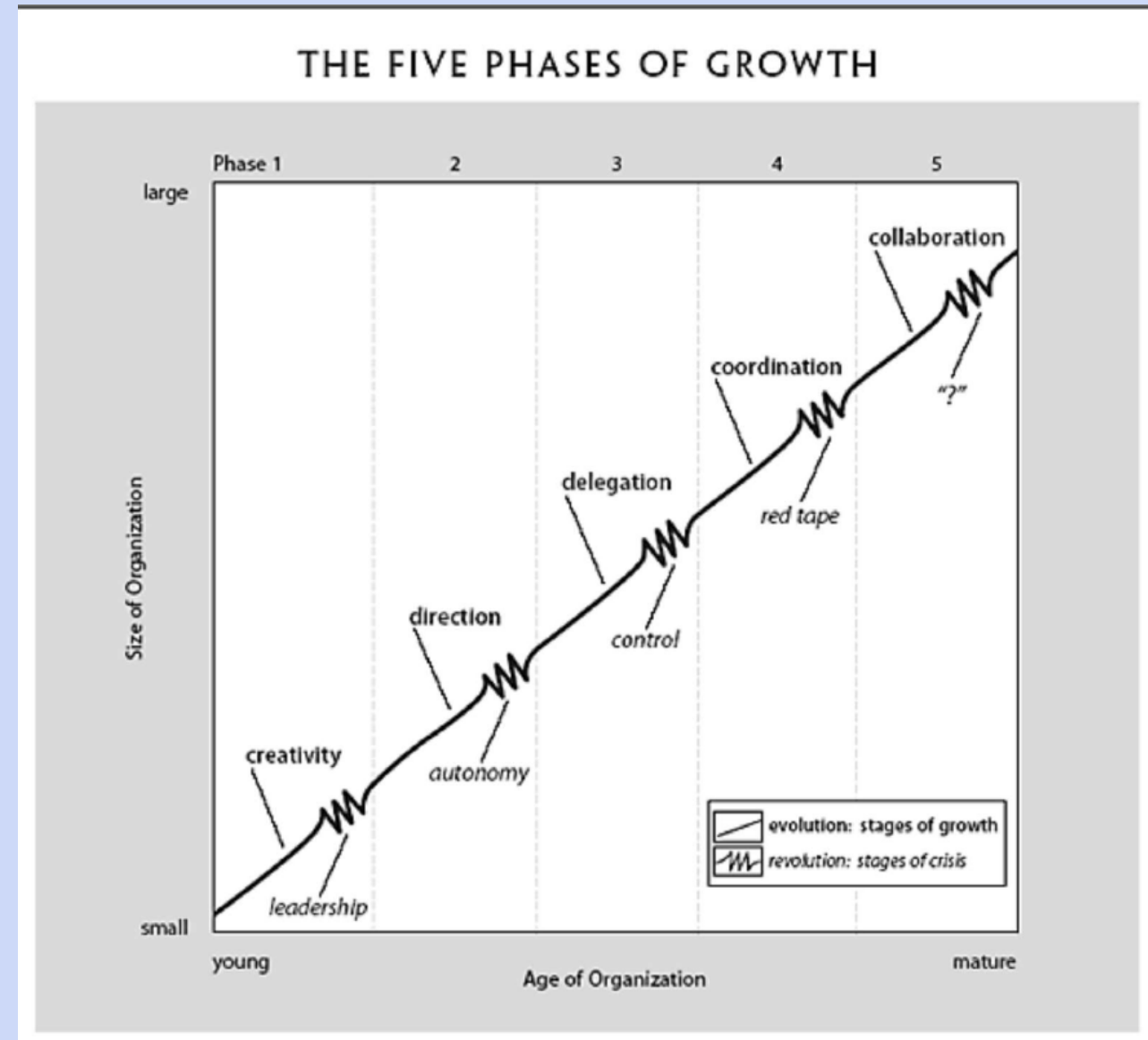
S-curve



Jumping the S-curve



Where do we think Lifemark is on this curve?



Pace is important.

Sustained growth demands strategic investment – new skills and capabilities are essential to adopting innovative ways of working. Making these investments thoughtfully as the company evolves is key to long-term success.

Bridging the strategy-execution gap



1

Right team

2

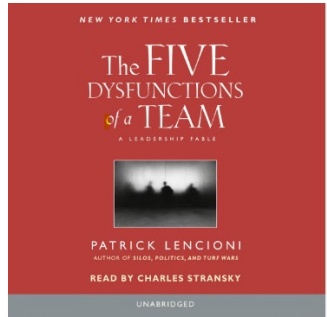
Discipline

3

Buy-in

RIGHT TEAM

Building a high-functioning team takes effort



Recommended reading:

Five
Dysfunctions of
a Team by
Patrick Lencioni



Trust One Another

When team members are genuinely transparent and honest with one another, it forms a safe environment that creates and builds vulnerability-based trust.

Engage in Conflict Around Ideas

With trust, team members are able to engage in unfiltered, constructive debate of ideas.

Commit to Decisions

When team members are able to offer opinions and debate ideas, they feel heard and respected, and will be more likely to commit to decisions.

Hold One Another Accountable

Once everyone is committed to a clear plan of action, they will be more willing to hold one another accountable.

Focus on Achieving Collective Results

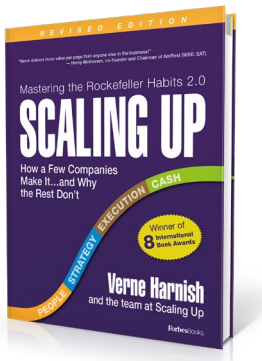
The ultimate goal is the achievement of results, unlocked through implementing the model's principles of Trust, Conflict, Commitment, and Accountability.

DISCIPLINE

Translating strategy into an operating plan

Highlights from Scaling Up & The Rockefeller Habits for Execution:

1. The **executive team** is healthy and aligned
2. Everyone is aligned with the **#1 thing that needs to be accomplished this quarter** to move the company forward
3. **Communication (and meeting) rhythm** is established and information moves through organization accurately and quickly
4. Every facet of the strategy has a person assigned with **accountability for ensuring goals are met**
5. Reporting and **analysis of customer feedback data** is **as frequent and accurate as financial data**
6. All employees can **answer quantitatively whether they had a good day or week**

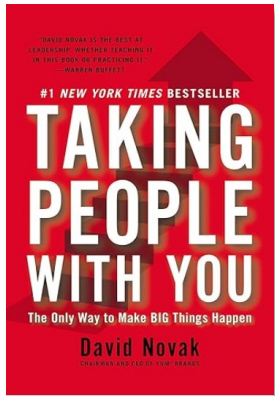


Recommended
reading:
Scaling Up by
Verne Harnish

BUY-IN

Importance of bringing people along in the journey

“You can’t lead a great organization of any size without getting your people aligned, enthusiastic, and focused relentlessly on the mission.”



Recommended reading:
Taking People with You by David Novak

Cultivating a culture of performance

Making it 'ok' to fail

Celebrating wins

Always-on communications approach

"You are the same today as you'll be in five years **except for two things**: the people you meet and the books you read."

- *Charlie "Tremendous" Jones*



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Key Takeaways

- Always keep an open-mind along your career journey.
- Organizations grow in predictable phases, leadership teams need to be fit-for-size.
- Strategic context and organizational readiness is very important.
- Strategies fail – learn from the failures.
- Execution requires leaders to build and tend to the team, and implement a disciplined management model, all while capturing the hearts and minds of the Company.
- ... always be reading, networking and most importantly delivering results.



Discussion, Q&A